Lesson 3: Documents and Meetings: Summarise, Ask, Check

Module 1 | 60 minutes | Summaries you can trust | Adults (18+) · ages 18–65

Objective: Use AI to summarise a long document, turn meeting notes into action items with owners and dates, ask questions of a document, and check every answer against the original.

Success criteria

- I can write a summary prompt with a reader, a length and section numbers.
- I can ask questions of a document in two tools.
- I can turn meeting notes into action items with owners and deadlines.
- I can check an AI summary against the original and correct it.

Key vocabulary

- **summary**: A short version of a long document that keeps the important points.
- **source**: The document or web page an answer comes from. In NotebookLM, the files you add.
- **citation**: A marker or reference that shows exactly where an answer came from.
- **action item**: A task from a meeting with a clear owner and deadline.
- **attach / upload**: Add a file to the chat with the paperclip or + button.

You will need

- Projector or screen share with Kitabash and the AI tools for this lesson
- Devices: 1 per learner (laptop, tablet or phone)
- Learner accounts only where allowed: see the course safety notes
- Printed worksheet (optional)
- Project files: l03_document_brief_kit.md, practice_policy_document.md, l03_teacher_demo_script.md

Timed lesson plan (60 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up game**	Telephone game with a number and a date (see Unplugged).
4 min	**Watch**	Play the lesson video. Pause at the 30-days answer: poll “Would you have believed it?”
7 min	**Live demo**	Summary in Claude, a question in ChatGPT checked against section 6.1, the same question in NotebookLM, meeting notes in Gemini.
8 min	**Prompt Lab 1**	Prompt Lab: a summary you can check, then run it on the practice policy.
6 min	**Breakout pairs: fact hunt**	Pairs check five numbers in their AI summary against the original. First pair to find a real mistake shares it.

7 min	**Prompt Lab 2**	Prompt Lab: meeting notes to action items, then the “ready to share?” sort game.
10 min	**Build along**	Make a one-page brief: summarise, ask three questions, check in NotebookLM, fix and label.
5 min	**Show-and-tell**	Two learners show their brief and one correction they made.
5 min	**Probe**	Spot the summary mistake, how to check a summary (order), and the right tool (individual).
3 min	**Wrap-up**	Exit ticket and homework.

Unplugged warm-up

Telephone game (5 min): whisper a three-part instruction with a number and a date down a line of 5 learners (“Send the bills to Accounts within 15 days, but not after 60”). Compare the last version with the original on the board. Say: “This is what can happen with summaries. Always check the original.”

Teaching the idea

Office life is full of long documents and messy meetings. AI can read a 12-page policy in seconds, but it can also blend two numbers or invent a deadline. Teach three habits: summarise for a reader and purpose; always ask for section or page numbers; and check every date, amount and name against the original. Show two ways to ask questions of a document: attach it in Claude or ChatGPT, or add it as a source in NotebookLM, which shows the exact lines used. Finish with meeting notes turned into action items with owners and deadlines, with gaps marked as missing.

Analogy: An AI summary is like a colleague’s notes from a meeting you missed: very helpful, but before you act on a number, you look at the minutes yourself.

Live demo: 1) Download the practice policy from the lesson files (it is fictional and safe). 2) In Claude, attach it and type the summary prompt from the video. Point at the section numbers. 3) In ChatGPT, attach it and ask: “How many days do I have to submit a travel claim after I return?” Then open section 6.1 together and check. 4) Open NotebookLM, create a notebook, add the same file, ask the same question and click the numbered marker. 5) Paste the meeting notes into Gemini with the action-item prompt and point at the MISSING cells.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
What makes a summary prompt better than “summarise this”?	Saying who it is for, the length, asking for section numbers and key dates and amounts.
Why ask for section or page numbers?	So you can check each point in the original quickly.
What does NotebookLM do differently?	It answers from the sources you add and shows clickable markers to the exact lines.

What three things does every action item need?	A task, an owner and a deadline.
Two tools give different answers. Who wins?	The original document.

Differentiation

Support
Give learners the summary prompt and the action-item prompt as copy-paste text; they focus on checking. Pair slower readers to check one section each.

Stretch
Ask NotebookLM for a list of “questions new staff will ask” about the policy, then check three answers against the original.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
If AI summarised it, I do not need to read the original.	Check every date, amount and name in the original before you act or share.
NotebookLM cannot be wrong because it uses my file.	It is much more grounded, but you still click the markers and read the lines.
It is fine to upload any office document.	Only public or practice documents in personal accounts; confidential files stay out.
The AI should fill in missing owners so the table looks complete.	Missing is useful information. Ask the team instead of guessing.

Assessment

Use the Prompt Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
Name one mistake an AI summary can make, and how you would catch it.

Homework
Take one public document from your work (a circular, a product manual, a government notice) and make a checked one-page brief. Note one thing the AI got wrong or left out.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Prompt Lab: a summary you can check (perform · ai lab)

Checklist: Who it is for · Length or format · Ask for section or page numbers · Ask for key dates and amounts · What to do if unclear

Strong example:

```
Summarise the attached policy for new staff in one page of bullet points: what changed, every deadline, date and amount. Put the section number after each point. If something is unclear or not in the document, say so and do not guess.
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2. Prompt Lab: meeting notes to action items (perform · ai lab)

Checklist: Ask for action items or tasks · Ask for an owner for each · Ask for a deadline for each · Ask for a table · Mark missing information

Strong example:

```
Turn these meeting notes into a table of action items with three columns: Task, Owner, Deadline. If an owner or deadline is not mentioned, write MISSING. Do not invent names or dates. Notes: Diwali stock — Zoya to order by 20 Oct. Kabir check godown space. New price list to all shops before Diwali. Arjun fix billing printer Friday.
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3. Is this action item ready to share? (perform · categorize)

Ready: has a task, owner and deadline: Zoya — order Diwali stock — by 20 Oct, Arjun — fix billing printer — Friday, Meera — share PTM slots with parents — 5 Nov
Not ready: something is missing: Check godown space, Someone to send the price list soon, Discuss the new software sometime

4. Spot the summary mistake (perform · multiple choice)

Answer: The AI mixed up two rules: claims are due in 15 days, but are refused only after 60 days

5. How to check a summary (perform · ordering)

Order: Ask for section or page numbers in your prompt → Read the summary and highlight every date, amount and name → Open the original at each section number → Correct anything that does not match → Add a note: “Made with AI help, checked against the original”

6. New situation: the right tool (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: Add the guide as a source in NotebookLM and click the numbered markers to check

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** summary = A short version of a long document that keeps the important points. · source = The document or web page an answer comes from. In NotebookLM, the files you add. · citation = A marker or reference that shows exactly where an answer came from. · action item = A task from a meeting with a clear owner and deadline.
2. **Prompt Lab: a summary you can check:** Include: Who it is for; Length or format; Ask for section or page numbers; Ask for key dates and amounts; What to do if unclear. Example: Summarise the attached policy for new staff in one page of bullet points: what changed, every deadline, date and amount. Put the section number after each point. If something is unclear or not in the document, say so and do not guess.
3. **Prompt Lab: meeting notes to action items:** Include: Ask for action items or tasks; Ask for an owner for each; Ask for a deadline for each; Ask for a table; Mark missing information. Example: Turn these meeting notes into a table of action items with three columns: Task, Owner, Deadline. If an owner or deadline is not mentioned, write MISSING. Do not invent names or dates. Notes: Diwali stock – Zoya to order by 20 Oct. Kabir check godown space. New price list to all shops before Diwali. Arjun fix billing printer Friday.
4. **Is this action item ready to share?:** Ready: has a task, owner and deadline: Zoya — order Diwali stock — by 20 Oct, Arjun — fix billing printer — Friday, Meera — share PTM slots with parents — 5 Nov · Not ready: something is missing: Check godown space, Someone to send the price list soon, Discuss the new software sometime
5. **Spot the summary mistake:** B. The AI mixed up two rules: claims are due in 15 days, but are refused only after 60 days — Section 6.1 has two numbers: submit within 15 days (late claims need approval) and no payment after 60 days. The AI blended them. This is why you check every number.

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